

Development at an “almost complete standstill”?

The developers' June 2021 warning about construction waste

THE CLAIM

“...development will come to an ‘almost complete standstill.’” (MaltaToday)

Malta Developers Association, statement of 2 June 2021, as reported by MaltaToday

Conditional on no solution to dumping being found.

Only the words in quotation marks are the Association's; the framing is the outlet's.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

No standstill in the data, but the condition was never tested.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+5.8%

Construction output, 2021

Volume rose 5.8% in 2021 and 5.5% in 2022 (Eurostat, 2015 = 100: 145.5, 154.0, 162.5).

2.1 Mt

Construction waste, 2022

Down from 3.0 Mt in 2020 but above 2018 (2.0 Mt). Construction is 78% of Malta's waste.

€12/t

Fixed gate fee since 2020

Set by government after road works stopped; contractors said it strained tenders in June 2021.

15

Measures, Oct 2021 strategy

The government announced a construction and demolition waste strategy four months later.

No data

Latest output figure: 2022

Eurostat has no later year for Malta; we found no published series of quarry intake.

FAIR TO SAY

The shortage of disposal space was real: road works halted in 2020 and contractors raised it again in 2021. A warning is not a forecast with a method; no one has shown a standstill was near.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ ERA: quarry intake and capacity by year.

☐ MDA: the evidence behind “almost complete standstill”.

☐ Government: status of the 2021 strategy's measures.

☐ NSO: construction output after 2022.